PERSONAL STATEMENT

EDWARD VARVAK

Dear reviewers,

Thank you for considering me for an MSCS scholarship. Throughout my four years of graduate school at UIC, I've found myself further and further drawn into my research, my department, and graduate student line in general. I've decided to pursue a post-doctoral position, and a scholarship would go a long way in helping me secure one.

My research lies at the intersection of Hodge theory, algebraic geometry, and number theory. Under the guidance of my advisor Ben Bakker, I've studied the interaction between Lagrangian fibrations and the moduli spaces of Abelian varieties. This work has been quite fruitful: I have already written and submitted my first paper for review, and am on track to complete a second within the next six months.

I've received much from our math community, and I've sought to give back in equal part. Beyond organizing the graduate algebraic geometry seminar, I've taken initiative to organize several reading groups, including the current one on the Weil conjectures and the past one on Lie groups. I've served on the geometry advisor panel, and consistently make myself available to help younger graduate students navigate the challenges of graduate school.

I've entered my fourth year, and it is my busiest yet. Next year, I will start applying for post-doctoral positions. I'm eager to share my work with experts in my field, and to get their insights on possible directions for my future research. My next step will therefore be to travel to different schools, give talks, and engage with other colleagues and potential collaborators. I'm thrilled to have the opportunity of presenting my results at the Institute for Advanced Study this November, and I intend to visit more institutions this Spring and next Fall. This will prove to be an essential part of securing a post-doc and establishing my future collaborative relationships.

To that end, I am doing what I can to acquire extra funding. My teaching assistantships and RTG fellowships have been more than enough to support me thus far, but the scope of my travels will be out of reach of my standard income. And while my advisor has been nothing but supportive in letting me use his grant money for travel, he has two other students' and his own travel to consider. A scholarship from the department would therefore go a very long way for my current and future academic endeavors. It would allow me to decide my travels free of worry about budgeting issues, and would set the stage for a good post-doc. I appreciate the time you took to read this, and I thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Edward Varvak